

competition, connection, and also simply the fun attached to it. That makes consistency much easier.

The best fitness programme is not merely the one that looks perfect on paper. It is the one that becomes part of your lifestyle. If somebody hates the gym but loves swimming, I would much rather have that person swim consistently than force themselves through a workout they dislike for three weeks, only to soon stop altogether. If somebody enjoys tennis, play tennis. If padel gets you moving four times a week, fantastic. Health is created by what you repeatedly do.

However, there is one important distinction: Movement and structured training are not the same thing. Sport is fantastic for cardiovascular fitness, coordination, reaction, mobility, mental health, and social connection. But depending on the activity, it may not provide enough resistance to maintain muscle mass, bone density, and strength, particularly as we get older.

So, instead of asking whether sport will replace the gym, perhaps we should change the question: How can



Clockwise from facing page: With the gym no longer the centre of the healthcare universe, people are running, cycling, trekking, and more, turning fitness into a community activity